Mesa
SCHOOL OF BUSINESS

Refernce deck
Power of Communicaition (Verbal and Written)



Chirantan Bhabhra

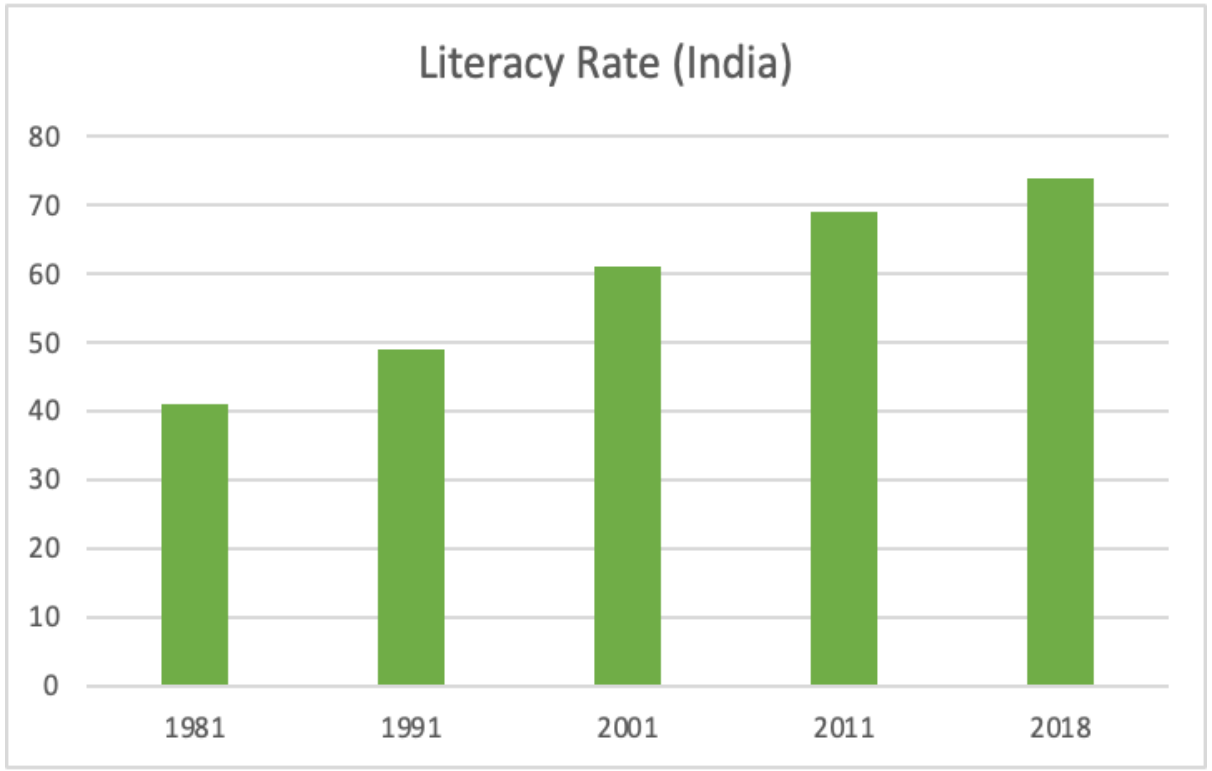
Storytelling coach | Business, Data and Sales Storytelling | Effective Written Communication | Solopreneur | Udaan | Retail - Innovation & Tech | Startups | Snapbizz - Ex Board Member | P&G | IIMA

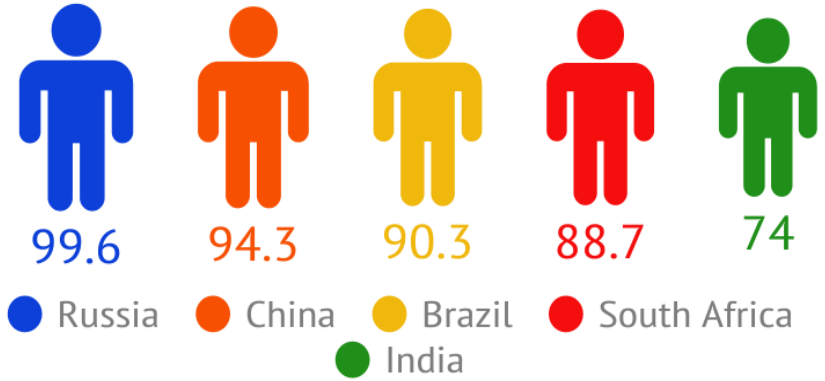
7 Cs

- Clear: no vague words
- Concise: only whats needed, don’t ramble
- Concrete: specific, use sizes positions
- Correct: facts, grammar, spelling; no contradictions
- Complete: in all aspects of the topic, don’t skip steps
- Courteous: tonality, calm
- Considerate: tailored to audience: assume other person is confused

Narrative of a slide

India has shown significant growth in Literacy rates, but still lag behind other within BRICS nations





Figures in %, Source: UNDP

Messages: How to apply

- Choose a slide deck you consider important for you
- Take one slide at a time
- Write a message on top: you can write up to 2 lines
  - **ASK yourself “What will I say when this slide comes up” ?**
  - **Whats the most 2-3 important points (or Data) I wish to highlight ?**

- A message should try to mention “what is happening in the slide” or “Whats the key takeaway” or highlight of a slide

- If you are done with 1 slide, message one more… then one more …

Showcasing your slide narratives!!

Bye Bye charts, welcome Infographics

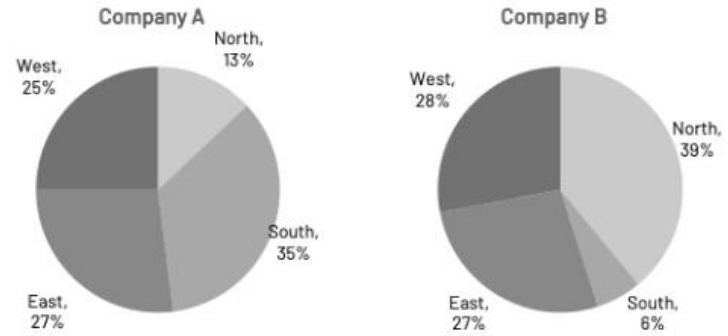
How much's that cuppa?

Here's what you'll need to shell out for a cup of chai

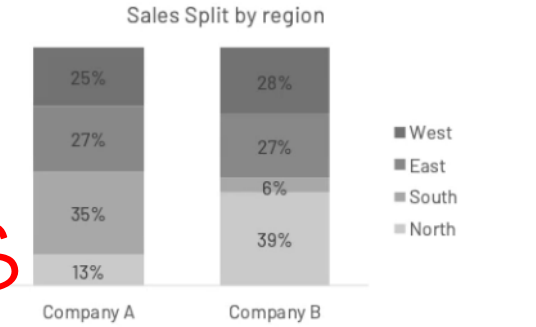


Which chart would you use ?

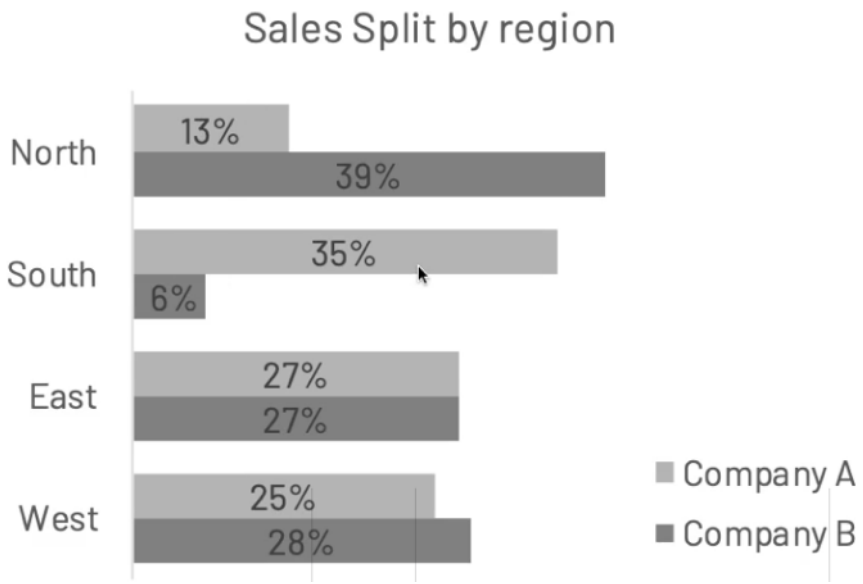
1 Two Pie Charts



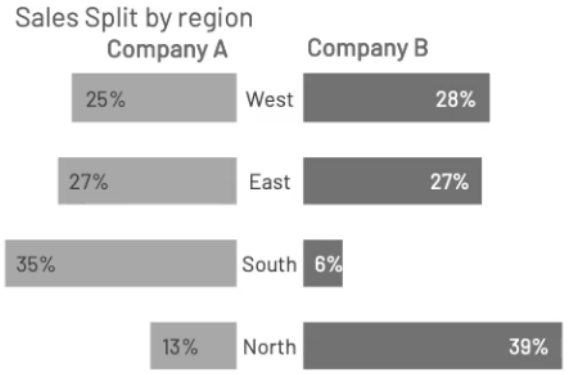
2 Stacked Column Chart



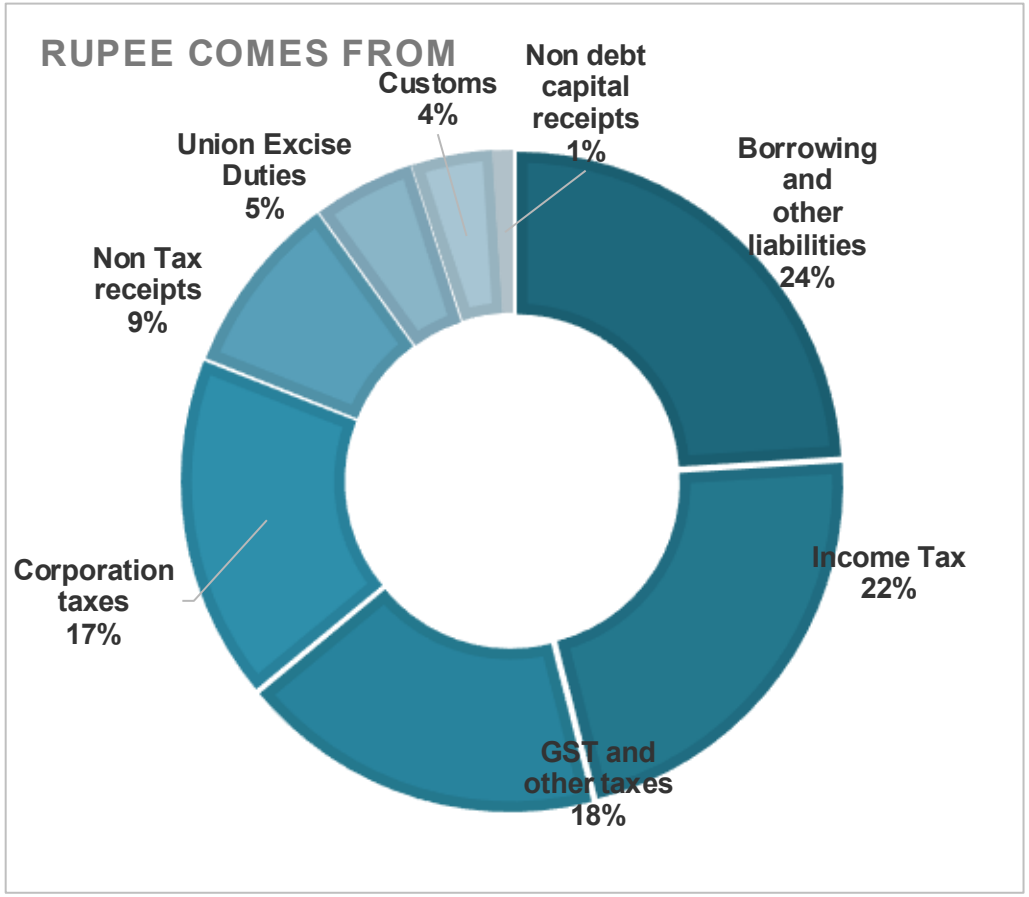
IT DEPENDS

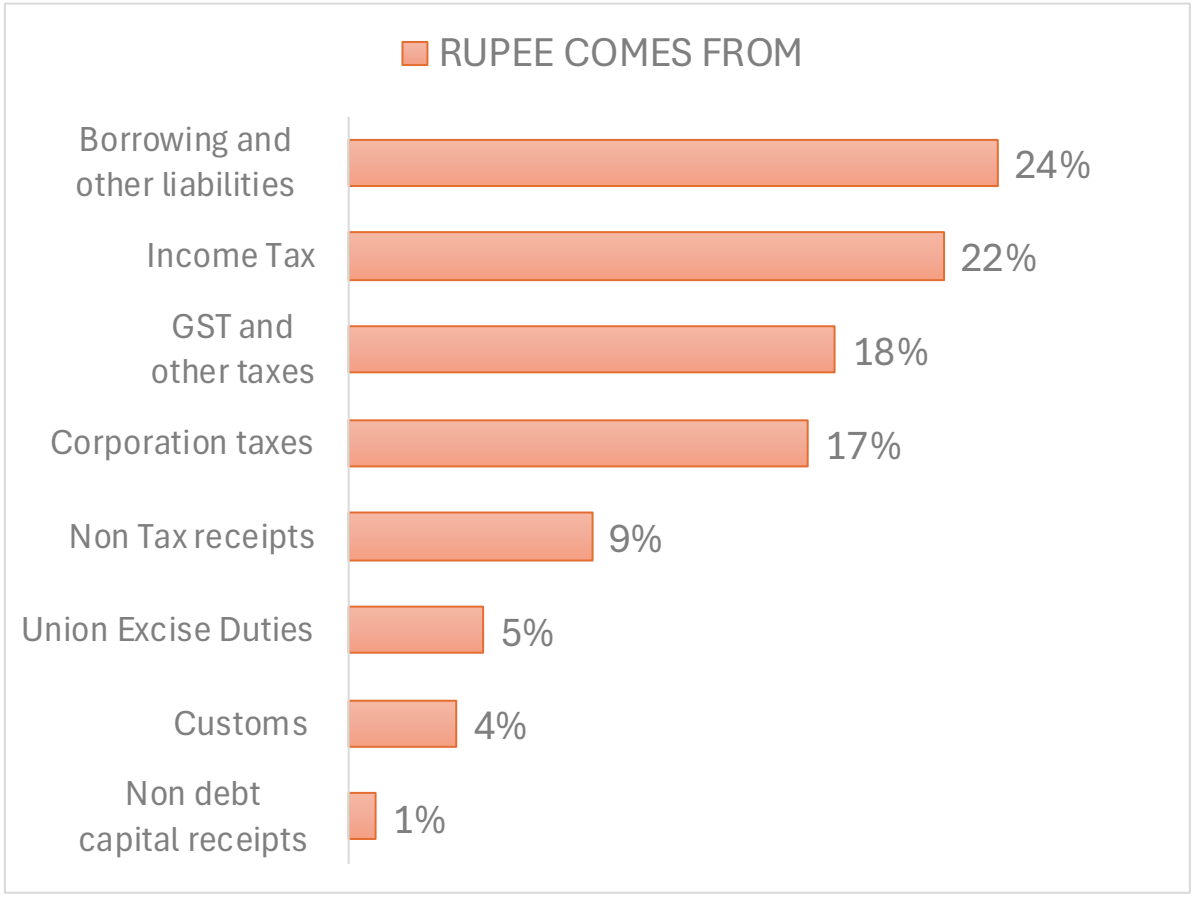


4 Deviation Bar Chart



Replace pie charts with bar / column (normal, stacked or cluster)





Key learning: Choose a Message first, chart type next

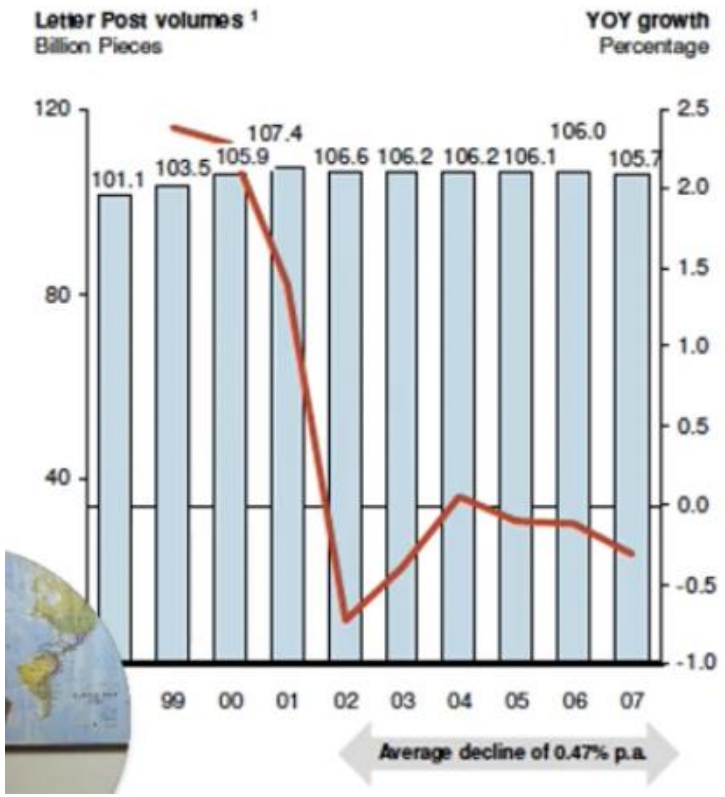
Try replacing Pies with bars and columns (simple, cluster or stacked). They are more readable

Use Infographics and visuals: Icons, visuals from online sources

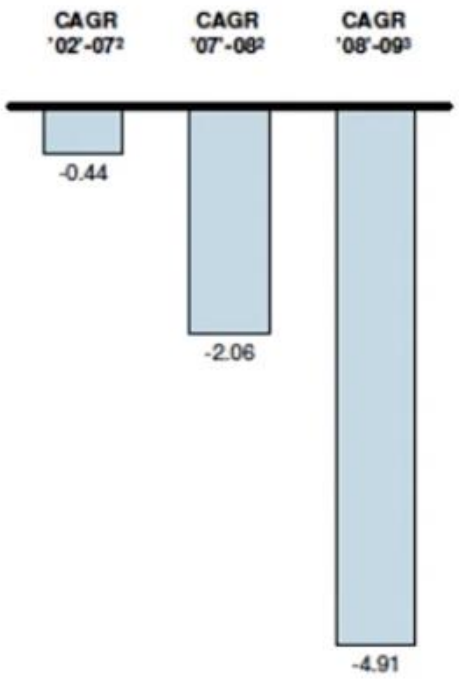
Example: Comic book style of writing slide

The decline of mail volumes is accelerating and increasingly disconnected from economic growth

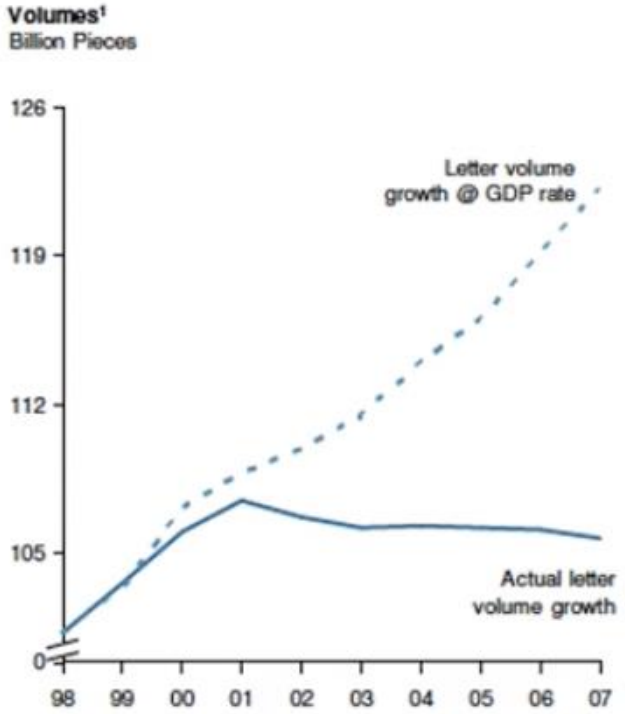
International posts have experienced steady decline in mail volumes since 2002...



... accelerating in 2008 and 2009



Growing disconnect between mail volumes and GDP indicates loss of relevance



To unclutter slides, use the following tools

Split slides

Remove redundancies (repeats)

CATS (not too many Colours, aligned elements, choiceful Text, Space as boundary)

BLUF (Bottom Line Up Front)

Comic Book Style of Writing

Unclutter your charts

An impactful narrative in business presentation?

The Structure

Nandan Nilekani’s presentation: The flow

Internet is having a moment of reckoning
Data is inexorable, but our approach to it isn’t
This is a global problem, with no single correct answer
Every nation is figuring out its own approach to Data
Meanwhile India - 2 is rapidly going digital
This is not a pipe dream
India will go from Data poor to Data rich in 3 years
Data shouldn’t just be protracted, data must be used to empower
Meaningful choice means interoperability and data portability



Why storytelling works?



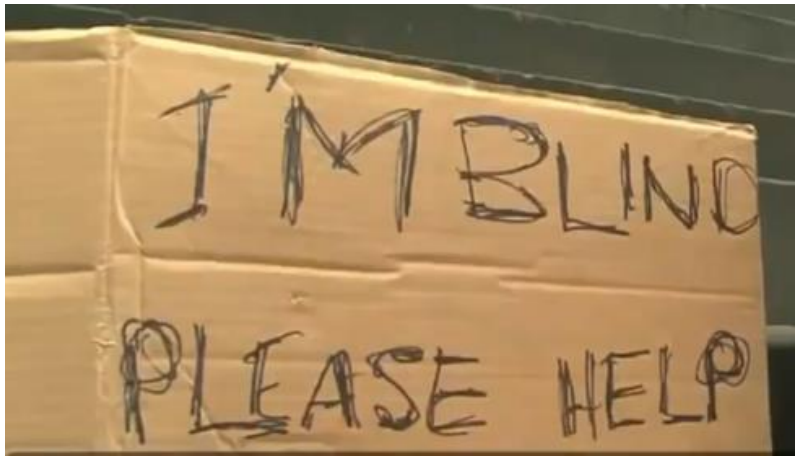
Stories are memorable

Stories hold attention

Stories inspire to act

Principles of Storytelling

Principle: Building Common Ground

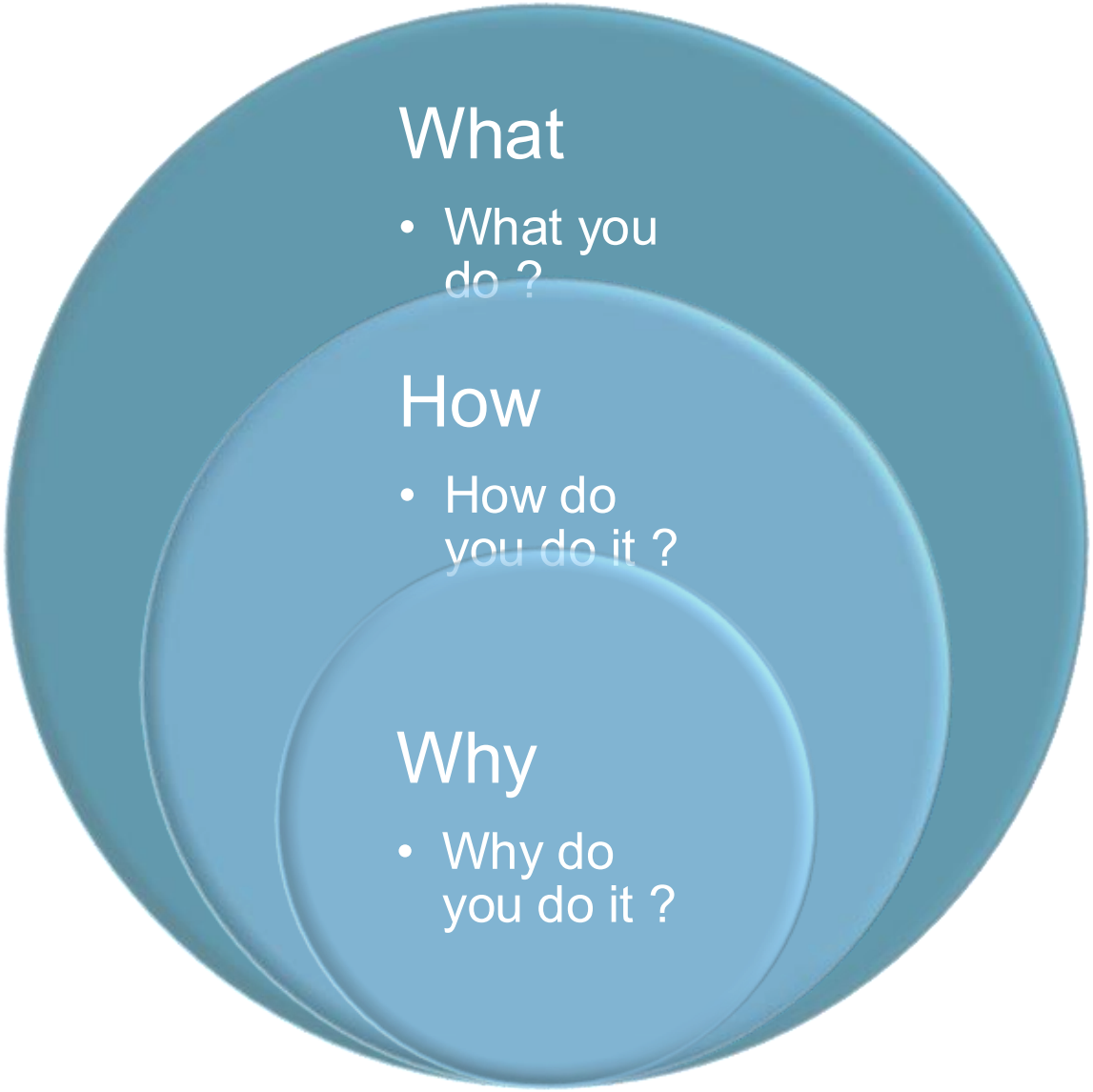


I



We (you and me)

Golden Circle by Simon Sinek



Why before what: communicating the impact

- My cloudification project improved 25% productivity of our team and saved 1million $ on cost. This was achieved by covering all our process approvals and inter functional interactions / engagements on cloud across 16 locations.

- I worked on a cloudification project which covered 16 locations multi-functional engagements and processes. It was delivered in the past 6 weeks and done using only in house experts from our company

Key questions on investors mind ?



Is this the right (large) problem to solve?

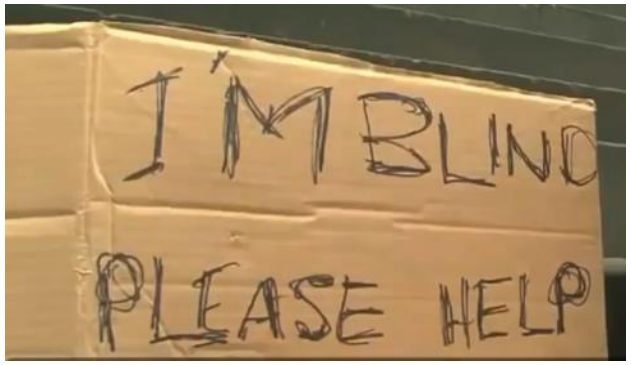


Is the solution proposed the right solution ?



Are these the right set of people

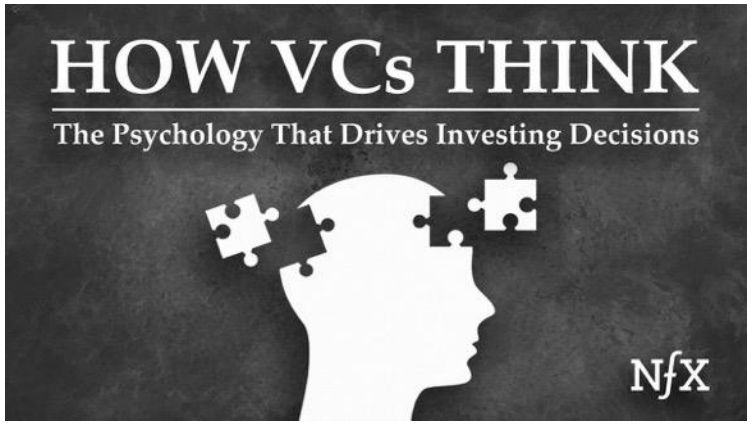
Principle: Purpose of story is emotional transportation



Fact and Action



Adjective





Key learning: Use of human stories and humanize numbers

Give your problem a face – tell an emotional (and real) story of an individual customer / beneficiary of your product / service / effort on how their lives become better

Represent the numbers as “every X out of Y” for humanizing them and making them memorable

Imagery using words

Universal story structure:
Context/ Character -> Conflict -> Resolution





You've got
a problem.
But we've got
a culinary cure.



How to write a single person story

Character (with an objective)

- Name , Location , Time period (when did the story take shape ?), Age (if needed)
- Context / Objective of the character

Conflict

- Details of what is happening with the character in the moment…
- …and its not a conflict / problem of one person, it is across xx..

Resolution

- Whats your recommendation

- Lets write one for benefits of UPI

Its true: You need to BLUF your way ahead !!

Its true: You need to BLUF your way ahead !!

The inefficient long winded way

A There's a problem with your hotel booking for the conference in Mumbai. I could only book Tuesday and Wednesday night; the hotel is already full on Monday night. I tried several others, but there's nothing to be had anywhere because of the Electronics Fair. (I haven't tried guest houses yet). According to the new summer timetable, there's a flight on Tuesday morning at 9.30. The arrival time in Mumbai is 10.30 local time. As the conference begins at mid-day and the journey from the airport will take you about an hour, you will still arrive on time. The travel office has booked a seat for you already, just in case. And by the way: isn't it your wedding anniversary on Monday?

The Bottom Line upfront way

I would suggest you travel on Tuesday and not Monday for the following reasons

- Its your anniversary on Monday. You should be around here with your husband
- No hotels available on Monday night.
  - Don't worry you'd still catch a Tuesday flight and reach conference in time
  - I have made the bookings for hotel on Tuesday and Wednesday

You will read this first

And then this

Then comes the turn of this one

Insights from Ward Mapping of Siddharth Nagar



Reported concerns of Malaria & Water Logging

Reported concerns of Respiratory, Heart & Breathlessness

Identified Clusters:

1. Sunlight Phase 1 & 2
2. Siddharth Ext Pocket A
3. Kilokari village

Concerns shared by RWA members during FGDs:

a. Supply water not clean. Drinking water procured from outside.
b. Due to drainage issues, dirty water comes inside homes

Concerns shared by RWA members: Insights from Ward Mapping of Siddharth Nagar

Concerns:

a. Supply water not clean. Drinking water procured from outside
b. Due to drainage issues, dirty water comes inside homes

Identified Clusters:

1. Sunlight Phase 1 & 2
2. Siddharth Ext Pocket A
3. Kilokari village



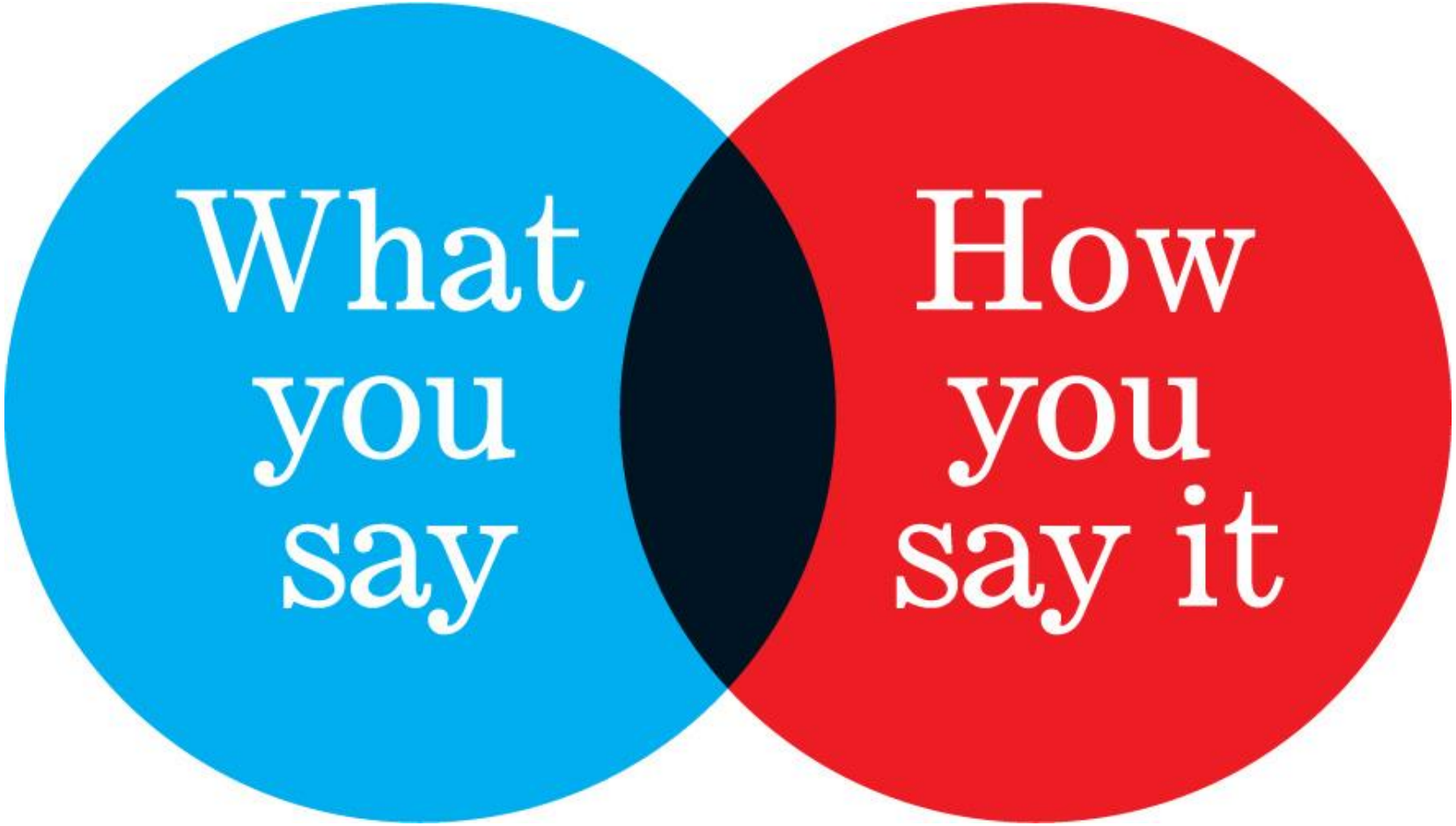
Reported concerns of Malaria & Water Logging

Reported concerns of Respiratory, Heart & Breathlessness

Lets build some analogies together: Founders

- Two factor authentication in banking app
- Depreciation
- Differentiating yourself vs competition OR
- IF your business is not commonly understood, how to explain it using analogy

Stories Are Truth Well Told



How to begin your narratives differently ?

- Quotation: there is one for everything
- Surprising data or fact / Quiz
- Demo / Experience of your product or service
- Dialogue / Verbatim / Feedback
- Single person story evoking an emotion. An employee, consumer, team, partner, vendor, leader







How to end better ?

- Quotations
- Numbers
- Verbatim / feedback / dialogue
- Echo your start: Loop back / call back something you mentioned earlier (at start)
  - Quotation with another related quote / revisit the quotation
  - Question with another repeat of the question or a related question
  - Story and outcome of the story
- Essence of the entire idea in a sentence as a summary
- Question “?”

What not to do ?

- Abrupt ending
- Be vague: Uh, I mean, yes I guess that’s what it is
- So, that’s us / / the product / me

What to do when you forget in your speech or you make a error

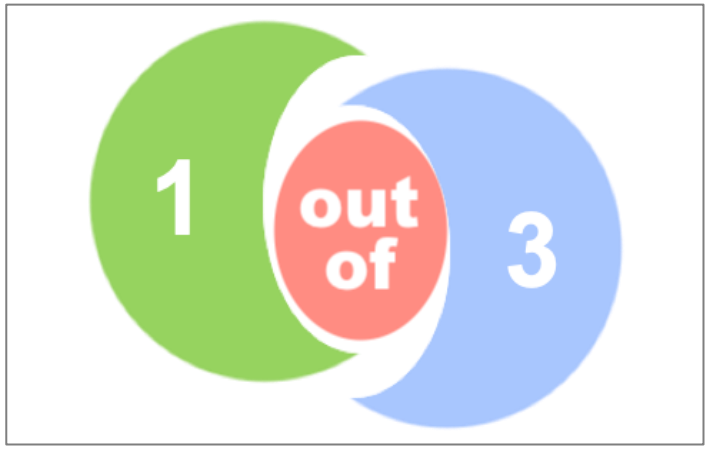
- “Give me just a second—I’m buffering… and it looks like my WiFi’s slow!”
- “Hold on, my brain just hit the pause button. Resume in 3… 2… 1…”
- “That thought just did a disappearing act. Let me find it backstage.”
- “Please stand by while I reboot my brain.”
- “I’m on a quick mental coffee break. Be right back!”
- “Looks like I momentarily lost my train of thought—hope it didn’t derail!”
- “This is the dramatic pause you didn’t know you needed.”
- “I promise this isn’t an awkward silence—it’s a plot twist!”
- “Just giving you time to appreciate the suspense.”
- “I swear I knew what I was going to say… it’s just playing hard to get.”

Data Narratives

Data Narrative Techniques



Contrast



Subitilization



Byte Sizing



Magnify and Compare

How do you contrast numbers?

Basic Parameters

Competition / Item
External benchmark/ rank vs industry
(”Industry avg is…”

Time
Movement over time
(”Usually it takes…” or “done in record time…”

Component
As a share of something else (% of national number, % of people etc): Problem is insignificant because only x%..

Advanced Parameters

Expectation
Compared to hypothesis
(“Edtech company in 2020 Q2 grew or decline sales ?”)

Context
Combination of circumstances which answer the question “Is this number higher or lower than it needs to be”

Elevator Pitches

Elevator Pitches: Introductions: Single statements

- “I / We / Brand Name” **help** X **achieve** Y **by doing** Z
  - **I** help professionals get more rewards, recognitions, results of their hard work by enabling them to tell better stories of their work
  - XX **helps** busy consumers **get** what they need conveniently and quickly **by** delivering food, groceries and every day essentials at their doorstep
  - YY **helps** beauty and personal-care shoppers **make** better, more informed beauty choices **by** bringing a wide range of products together with trusted content, reviews and recommendations

Elevator Pitches : Problem and solution statements

- Statement of a problem
- Statement of a solution (***I / We help X achieve Y by doing Z)***

Examples

- We all work very hard, but the perception of our work is way lesser than the reality of it. Storytelling is the best way to reach the hearts and minds of people.

- **I** help professionals get more rewards, recognitions, results of their hard work by enabling them to tell better stories of their work